# MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation Engineer

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer focused on CI/CD, test infrastructure and build tooling, with hands-on experience supporting three product teams. Built GitLab CI pipelines and Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster, and improved pipeline speed and test reliability through automation and measurement. Developing infrastructure-as-code and cloud skills through a personal k3s/GitOps homelab and Terraform work on Hetzner. Known for documenting technical workflows and helping teams adopt shared tooling.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**CI/CD and Infrastructure:** GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), Terraform (personal project), Argo CD
**Monitoring and Data:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
**Programming and Automation:** Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Ansible (basic)
**Testing:** pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
**Systems:** Linux, Git
**Cloud learning:** AWS fundamentals (EC2, S3); personal Hetzner VPS

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present**

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Created an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

**QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021**

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

**Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019**

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

## SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

**Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025**

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

**Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024**

- Delivered an automated workflow deploying a short-lived application, PostgreSQL and seeded-data environment for each merge request via GitLab CI and Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature review, with end-to-end tests running against them.

**CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022**

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.

**Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023**

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify recurring test issues; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

## EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

## CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified)

## LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)